SMM
Shanghai Metals Market

SMM IRON ORE DAILY

SMM Iron Ore Daily

2026-10-27 Tuesday · Imported & Domestic Ore · Prices · Supply–Demand · Inventory · Commentary

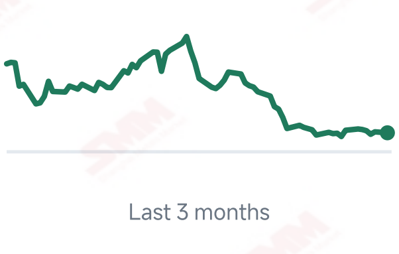
Source **SMM / SGX**

Futures Contracts

SGX: latest price · DCE: close

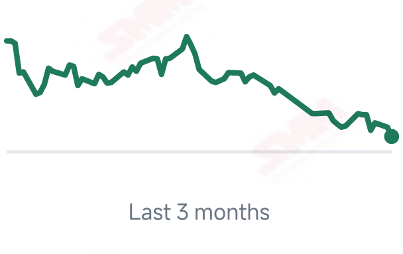
SGX Iron Ore Current-month Contract Latest price

90.60
USD/dmt
FEFV26 · 2026-10 · SGX
As of preparation: 2026-10-27 17:57:30 (UTC+8)
Quote time: 10-27 17:37:00 (UTC+8)


Last 3 months

DCE Iron Ore Most-traded I2701 Daily

664.0
yuan/mt
▼ -7.5 -1.12%
MTD avg **676.3**
As of Oct 27 · vs Oct 26


Last 3 months

SMM Iron Ore Price Index

Five MMi indices as of Oct 27

MMi 61% Port Spot Daily

650
yuan/wmt
▼ -4 -0.61%
MTD avg **658**

Last 3 months

MMi 58% Port Spot Daily

604
yuan/wmt
▼ -4 -0.66%
MTD avg **616**

Last 3 months

MMi 65% Port Spot Daily

810
yuan/wmt
▼ -3 -0.37%
MTD avg **819**

Last 3 months

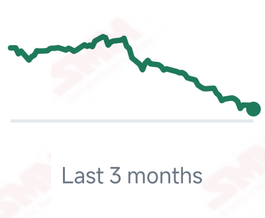
MMi 61% Seaborne Index Daily

88.70
USD/dmt
▼ -0.50 -0.56%
MTD avg **90.23**

Last 3 months

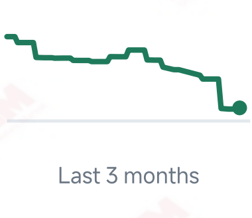
MMi 65% Seaborne Index Daily

106.15
USD/dmt
▼ -0.60 -0.56%
MTD avg **108.58**


Last 3 months

SMM Domestic Ore Composite Index Daily

797.36
yuan/mt
▲ +1.03 +0.13%
MTD avg **809.35**
As of Oct 23 · vs Oct 22


Last 3 months

Key View

Futures and spot remain under pressure; persistent buying matters as supply recovers

Today's weakness extended across futures, port prices and seaborne composite indices. DCE most-traded closed at 664.0 yuan/mt, down 1.12%, while the 61%, 58% and 65% port indices fell to 650, 604 and 810 yuan/wmt. The seaborne 61% and 65% indices were USD 88.70 and 106.15/dmt, both down about 0.56%. Most mainstream fines weakened, and relative strength in an individual product is insufficient to establish stronger support overall.

Supply flows and purchasing schedules remain important to the balance. Arrivals in China rose 12.47% WoW and global shipments increased 2.83% in the week to Oct 23, potentially adding to available resources. The latest modest rise in hot metal supports baseline consumption, but mill stocks, finished-steel margins and orders determine whether restocking becomes discretionary. Slightly lower freight cushions some costs without necessarily offsetting weaker selling prices.

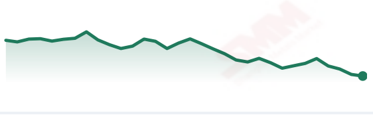
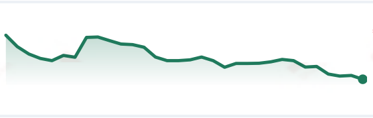
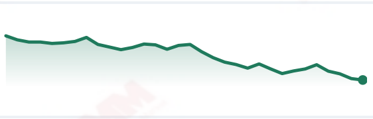
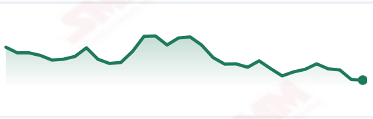
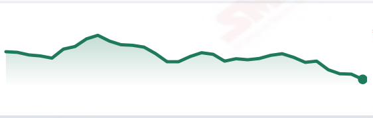
Actual transactions remain the near-term test of stabilisation. Needs-based buying could leave higher arrivals and existing stocks constraining a rebound. Improved mill margins followed by persistent collections and restocking would provide a firmer basis for support. A soft, range-bound outlook remains appropriate, distinguishing individual brand divergence from the broader demand trend.

Today's Highlights

- **Domestic futures and port spot prices weakened further.** DCE most-traded I2701 closed at **664.0 yuan/mt**, down 7.5 yuan (-1.12%) from Oct 26. Qingdao PB and Newman Fines were both 635 yuan/wmt and Mac Fines were 641, each down 5 yuan; Newman Lump fell 10 yuan to 810.
- **Both seaborne indices declined.** The 61% index was **USD 88.70/dmt**, down 0.50 (-0.56%), and the 65% was **106.15**, down 0.60 (-0.56%). Their spread narrowed from USD 17.55 to 17.45/dmt.
- **The low-grade port index fell slightly more in percentage terms.** The 61%, 58% and 65% port indices were 650, 604 and 810 yuan/wmt, down 4, 4 and 3 yuan. The 65%-58% spread widened from 205 to 206 yuan/wmt.
- **Most seaborne brands fell, with some divergence.** Against the Oct 26 report, PB Fines were USD 89.05/dmt, Newman Fines 88.15 and Mac Fines 88.45, each down USD 0.50. SP10 rose USD 0.85 to 80.15 (+1.07%). This describes current pricing rather than establishing a broad improvement in demand.

Qingdao Port Imported Ore Spot Prices

yuan/wmt · tax incl.

Product	10-27 (yuan/wmt)	Daily change / %	MTD avg	Last 12 months
PB Fines 60.8% Daily	635	▼ -5 -0.78%	645	
Newman Fines 61.2% Daily	635	▼ -5 -0.78%	646	 *
Mac Fines 60.8% Daily	641	▼ -5 -0.77%	649	
BRBF 62.5% Daily	685	▼ -5 -0.72%	696	
Newman Lump 63% Daily	810	▼ -10 -1.22%	836	
Super Special Fines (SSF) 56.5% Daily	497	▼ -5 -1.00%	507	
Carajas Fines (IOCJ) 65% Daily	810	▼ -5 -0.61%	823	
PB Lump 61.5% Daily	810	▼ -5 -0.61%	829	 *

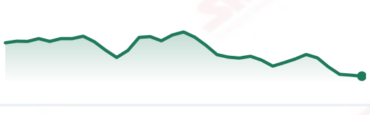
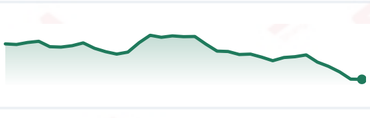
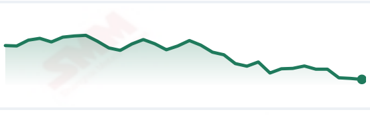
Seaborne Brand Prices in USD & MMi Indices

USD/dmt

Seaborne Brand Prices in USD CFR Qingdao

Product	10-27 (USD/dmt)	Daily change / %	10-26
Roy Hill Fines 62% Daily	85.60	▼ -0.50 -0.58%	86.10
SIMEC Fines 61% Daily	87.30	▼ -0.50 -0.57%	87.80
PB Fines 62% Daily	89.05	▼ -0.50 -0.56%	89.55
Newman Fines 60.7% Daily	88.15	▼ -0.50 -0.56%	88.65
Mac Fines 60.5% Daily	88.45	▼ -0.50 -0.56%	88.95
Jimblebar Fines 60.30% Daily	86.10	▼ -0.35 -0.40%	86.45
Carajas Fines (IOCJ) 65% Daily	105.00	▼ -0.50 -0.47%	105.50
SSFT / SSFG 60% Daily	96.00	▼ -0.50 -0.52%	96.50
Brazilian Blend Fines (BRBF) 64% Daily	95.55	▼ -0.50 -0.52%	96.05
RTX Fines 61% Daily	85.30	— 0.00 0.00%	85.30
West Pilbara Fines (WPF) 60% Daily	88.70	▼ -0.50 -0.56%	89.20
SP10 Fines 59%-60% Daily	80.15	▲ +0.85 +1.07%	79.30

SMM Iron Ore Price Index monthly statistics

Index	Month-to-date avg	MoM	YTD	Unit	Last 12 months
SMM MMi 61% Iron Ore Seaborne Index Daily	90.23	-6.51%	-16.3%	USD/dmt	
SMM MMi 65% Iron Ore Seaborne Index Daily	108.58	-5.11%	-12.5%	USD/dmt	
SMM MMi 61% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	658	-4.94%	-20.0%	yuan/wmt	
SMM MMi 65% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	819	-2.48%	-9.9%	yuan/wmt	
SMM MMi 58% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	616	-4.78%	-15.9%	yuan/wmt	
SMM China Domestic Ore Composite Price Index Daily	809.35	-3.48%	-10.1%	yuan/mt	

The seaborne 61% index was USD 88.70/dmt (-0.56%) and the 65% was 106.15 (-0.56%), narrowing their spread from USD 17.55 to 17.45/dmt. The 61%, 58% and 65% port indices were 650, 604 and 810 yuan/wmt, down 4, 4 and 3 yuan.

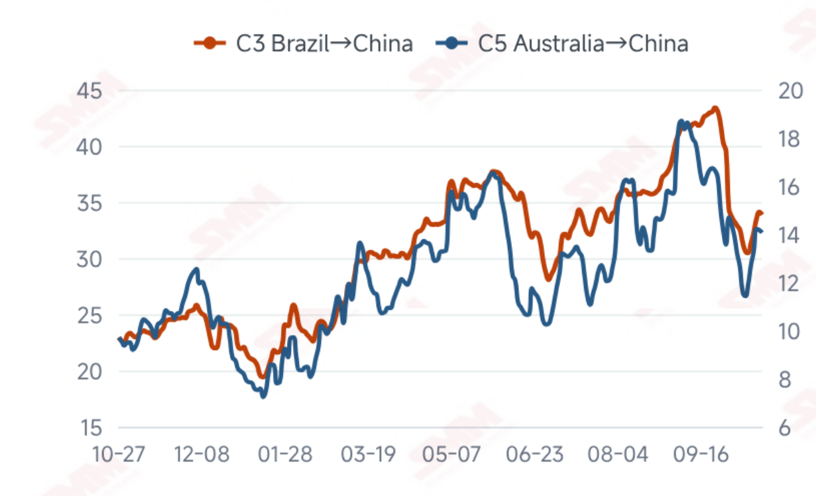
* SMM yuan quotations for Newman Fines and PB Lump start in Mar 2026; their sparklines cover that shorter window only. All others show the past year.

Key Price Drivers

Last 12 months

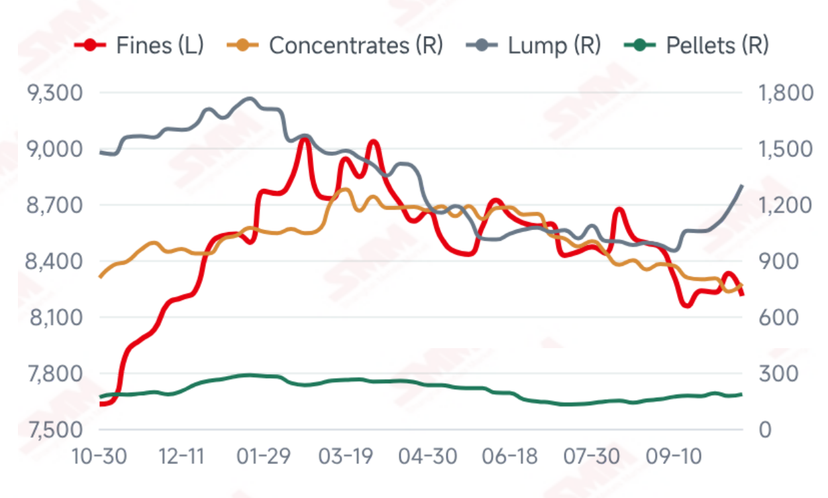
Iron Ore Ocean Freight

USD/mt · daily · last 12M · C3 Tubarão→Beilun/Baoshan, C5 W. Australia Dampier→Qingdao/Beilun/Baoshan



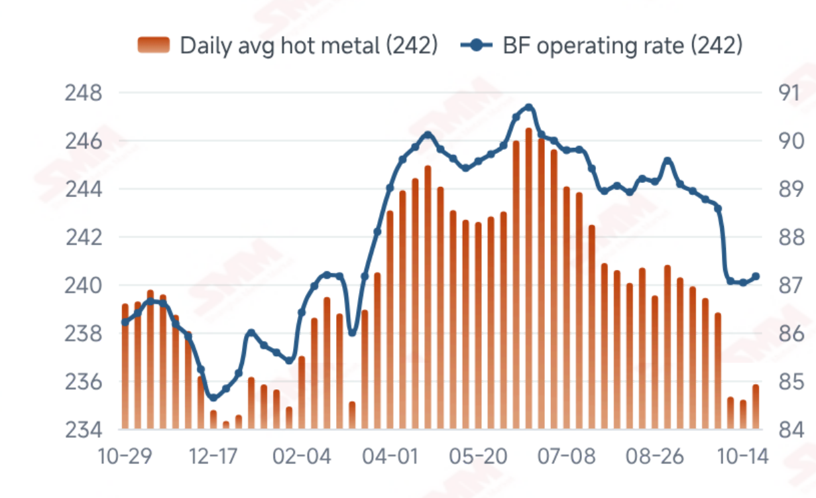
Iron Ore Port Inventory at 10 Ports · by Product

Left: fines Right: concentrates / lump / pellets · 10,000 mt · weekly



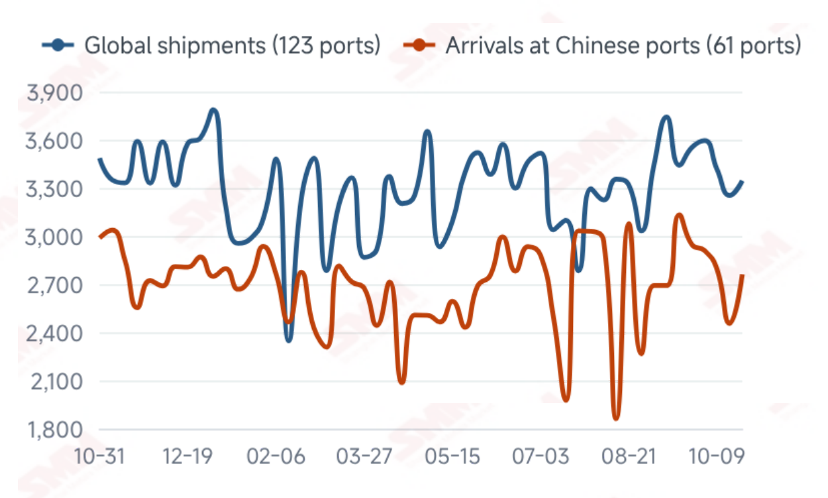
Daily Avg Hot Metal Output & BF Operating Rate, 242 Mills

Left: 10,000 mt Right: % · weekly



Global Iron Ore Shipments vs Arrivals at Chinese Ports

10,000 mt · weekly · shipments 123 ports / arrivals 61 ports



Market Commentary · Imported Ore

Futures & spot	DCE most-traded I2701 closed at 664.0 yuan/mt, down 1.12% from Oct 26. Qingdao PB Fines were 635, Newman Fines 635, Mac Fines 641, BRBF 685, SSF 497, Carajas Fines 810 and PB Lump 810 yuan/wmt, each down 5 yuan; Newman Lump fell 10 yuan to 810. SGX official current-month FEFV26 was last priced at USD 90.60/dmt, timestamped Oct 27, 17:37:00 (UTC+8). SMM's current daily review described needs-based mill purchases and moderate overall trading.
Drivers	Domestic futures, port indices and both seaborne composite indices declined together, indicating continued pressure on price support. Most seaborne brands weakened, and gains in an individual product did not change the broader soft pattern. Availability, purchasing schedules and blending economics may influence relative prices, but transactions are needed to validate explanations rather than attributing an isolated move to a specific supply or demand event.
Demand	The latest 242-mill survey showed daily hot metal output of 2.3584 million mt on Oct 21, up 6,400 mt WoW, with a blast furnace operating rate of 87.16%. Modest production improvement supports baseline consumption, but raw-material stocks, end-user orders and margins still constrain purchasing. Restocking restricted to current production needs could limit an ore rebound; sustained growth in transactions and collections would better confirm recovery.
Inventory & supply	Global shipments were 33.4494 million mt in the week to Oct 23, up 2.83% WoW, and arrivals in China were 27.6076 million mt, up 12.47%. Latest ten-port stocks were 104.6534 million mt on Oct 22, up 632,200 mt from Oct 15. Higher arrivals may add to available spot resources, while further inventory pressure depends on unloading schedules and mill collections.
Cost & margin	Oct 26 freight was USD 33.83/mt for C3, down 0.76% from the previous reading, and 14.05 for C5, down 0.78%. Lower transport costs may provide a cushion, but softer port selling prices could squeeze returns. Contract procurement prices, settlement timing and exchange rates jointly determine margins, so a daily price direction alone does not establish a specific profit. SMM's Oct 27 cost-and-margin assessment put the period's average import margin at 0.12 yuan/mt, down 4.45 yuan from 4.57; this measures import trading rather than steelmaking or coking profitability.

Market Commentary · Domestic Ore

Prices	SMM's Oct 27 Tangshan brief quoted 66% concentrate at 890–895 yuan/mt on a dry-basis, tax-inclusive delivered-to-mill basis, with prices relatively stable. The latest Domestic Ore Composite Price Index was 797.36 yuan/mt on Oct 23; region, grade and delivery terms distinguish the two measures.
Supply & demand	Low mining and beneficiation activity and relatively tight resources around Tangshan supported some quotations. However, mill losses and strong pressure on bids persisted, with no clear improvement in trading. Resource constraints coexist with cautious buying, leaving sales dependent on actual orders and collection schedules.
Outlook	SMM expects Tangshan concentrate prices to remain soft and range-bound near term. Further transmission of imported ore weakness may intensify bargaining pressure, while tight regional resources and recovering trading could keep some quotations relatively stable.

Market Factors

▲ Supportive factors

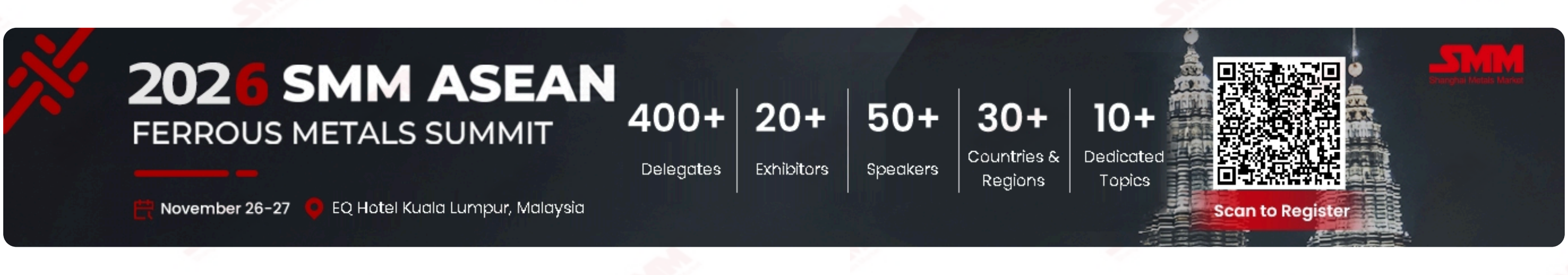
- Latest hot metal output rose 6,400 mt WoW, improving baseline consumption.
- C3 and C5 freight eased slightly, cushioning some transport costs.
- Resource constraints in some domestic regions may support offers.
- Lower prices could improve trading support if they attract sustained restocking.

▼ Bearish factors

- DCE fell 1.12% and all eight port products weakened.
- Both seaborne indices declined by about 0.56%.
- Latest arrivals in China rose 12.47% WoW as supply flows recovered.
- Orders, margins and stock management still constrain discretionary mill buying.

Flash News

- [SMM Iron Ore] Iron ore weakens as rising arrivals add to port stock pressure ↗
  2026-10-27
- [Domestic Iron Ore Brief] Market transactions were average. Iron ore concentrate prices in the Tangshan area may consolidate on a subdued note. ↗
  2026-10-27
- [SMM Coking Coal and Coke Daily Brief] 20261027 ↗
  2026-10-27
- [Severstal targets 2026 launch for Cherepovets pellet plant] ↗
  2026-10-27
- [SMM Steel] Indonesian HRC Holds at USD 515-520/mt FOB as Weak Demand Pressures Export Prices ↗
  2026-10-27
- [SMM Steel] India Domestic Steel Market Sees Weak Demand Ahead of festive holidays ↗
  2026-10-27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20+ Exhibitors
50+ Speakers
30+ Countries & Regions
10+ Dedicated Topics
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